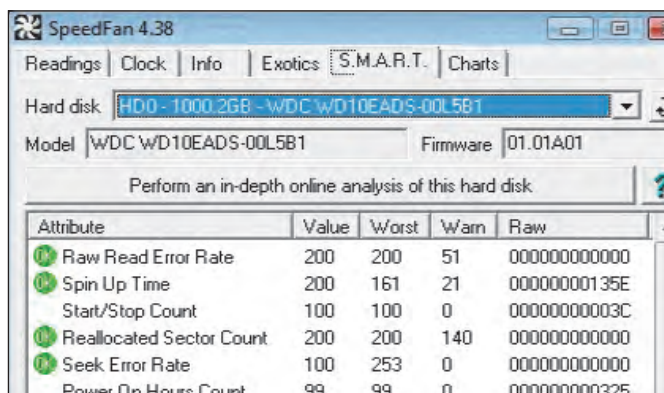


No Mac OS X

New Mac OS X 10.6.2 will be blocked from running on Intel's Atom processors

N-gage shutting

Nokia to discontinue the N-gage platform in the upcoming year



Speedfan's inbuilt hard drive diagnosing feature can display health of a hard drive

without any screen freezes or delays. Please guide me with understanding of the problem and help me with a solution to it.

Gaurav

If you have disabled USB booting, that itself should stop the drive from booting. Set your internal drive to boot first. If the external drive still boots, set the next boot drive as your internal hard drive. That should hopefully fix things. If that doesn't help either, maybe it's a bug with the motherboard. Look for a BIOS update and see if there are any bug fixes for it. If yes, then flash the BIOS. Remember that this is a Frisky thing to do and you can end up spoiling the board.

Random flashing

My PC configuration is:

- Intel Core 2 Duo E4600
- Gigabyte S2C 945 GCM mother board

- 2 GB DDR2 RAM
- 160 GB HDD Hitachi
- Samsung DVD writer
- Intex cabinet (450 W SMPS)
- Viewsonic 19-inch TFT with
- D-Sub connector

I have both Windows Vista and XP installed on my system.



Post your comments at <http://thinkdigit.com/d/dec09/>

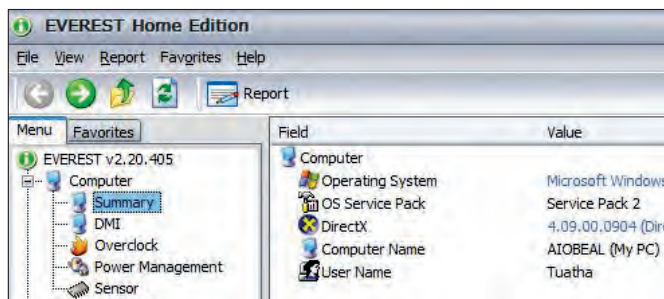


Whenever I boot in XP, Windows runs fine. But when I boot into Vista, the monitor goes blank randomly for fraction a second but rest of the time, it's fine.

My hard drive activity light flickers without any program running and its operation is noisy too. Also, my operating system keeps failing every now and then.

Is a 450-W power supply enough if I want to add an additional hard drive and a graphics card? Also, suggest a mid-ranged graphics card for my configuration.

Paramjit Singh



Everest showing an in-depth listing of the components of a system

Windows normally flashes the display just before it boots into the desktop. It shouldn't cause any serious problems. The hard drive LED flickering could be because of highly fragmented data. Try defragging the drive sometime. If the hard drive is really old, it could be an issue with the drive. Try running a diagnostic tool or use Speedfan's internal drive diagnosing feature. The noise and the system instability suggests there's something wrong with it. Backup your data before things get worse. The 450-W PSU will run an additional hard drive easily. Whether it runs the graphics card depends on the kind of card itself. A basic entry-level

Now my drive is locked on Region 3 and I'm unable to access any DVD. I haven't played any other DVDS of different regions. It happened accidentally and I only have Region 5 media. Please help me overcome this problem.

Chandrakanth

DVD drives have region protection built into them. For the sake of flexibility, a few changes are allowed every now and then. You shouldn't change the region at all. If you've exhausted all the allotted limit, you can't reset the region.

Windows boots very slowly

I'm an avid reader of Digit magazine. I have an Intel Dual Core 2 with Windows XP SP2 running on 1.5 GB RAM and 256 of graphics card memory. I also use Kaspersky Internet Security. Even then, my PC takes too much time to start. I have tried everything. I've removed unwanted startup programs, defragmented my drive, but it still takes a lot of time. Please help me. The Windows XP logo stays on screen for long.

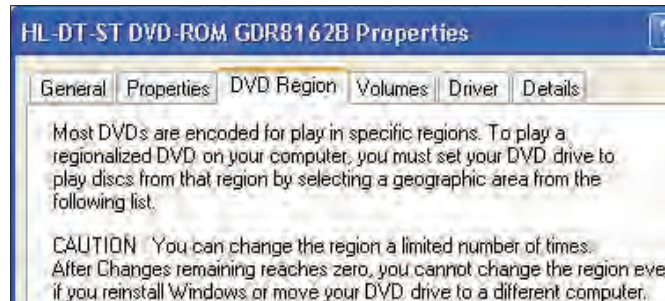
Jimeet shah

Try running a thorough disk scan to make sure the hard drive doesn't have any problems. Also, make sure you have all the drivers for the motherboard are installed. If nothing works, a format and then reinstall is worth doing.

card won't be a problem, but a high-end card might. Look for a GeForce 9600GT from Gigabyte, ZOTAC or ASUS.

DVD Protection

I have an LG Writer (GSA-H20N) that I purchased back in 2006. I have changed its region settings four times so far. Now, the region settings allowed shows up as only one. When I attempt to change that setting, it shows up an error message saying that the region setting cannot be changed. Make sure that you have Administrator privileges.



Region settings can only be altered a few times